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一、文章中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文以2006年世界杯优秀足球运动员更易在年初出生的反常现象为切入点，列举了对该现象的几种民间猜测，进而通过佛罗里达州立大学心理学教授安德斯·埃里克森的一系列研究，驳斥了“先天天赋决定卓越成就”的固有认知，最终提出全文核心结论：各个领域的顶尖高手几乎都是后天练就的，而非天生的，刻意练习才是提升能力的核心关键。

英文主旨

This passage starts with the abnormal phenomenon that elite soccer players in the 2006 World Cup are more likely to be born in the earlier months of the year. It lists several folk guesses about this phenomenon, then through a series of studies by Anders Ericsson, a psychology professor at Florida State University, refutes the inherent cognition that innate talent determines outstanding achievement. Finally, it puts forward the core conclusion of the full text: top performers in various fields are almost always made, not born, and deliberate practice is the core key to improving ability.

二、逐句精读解析

第一段

1. **原句**：If you were to examine the birth certificates of every soccer player in 2006's World Cup tournament, you would most likely find a noteworthy quirk: elite soccer players are more likely to have been born in the earlier months of the year than in the later months.

译文：如果你去查看2006年世界杯足球赛所有参赛球员的出生证明，你极有可能会发现一个值得关注的奇特现象：优秀的足球运动员更有可能出生在一年前的几个月，而非后几个月。

【核心词汇&短语】

- birth certificate 出生证明（考研核心短语）
- tournament /'tʊənəmənt/ n. 锦标赛，联赛（考研核心词）
- noteworthy /'nəʊtwɜ:ði/ adj. 值得注意的，显著的
- quirk /kwɜ:k/ n. 奇事，巧合；怪癖
- elite /eɪ'li:t/ adj. 精英的，优秀的 n. 精英

【长难句结构分析】

本句为**对将来情况的虚拟语气句**，句子主干为 **you would most likely find a noteworthy quirk**。

- 条件状语从句：**If you were to examine...tournament**，使用 **were to do** 结构，表达对将来的虚拟假设
- 冒号后的内容为同位语从句，对 **quirk** 的具体内容进行解释说明
- 比较结构：**more likely to...than in the later months**，对比球员出生时间的概率差异

2. **原句**：If you then examined the European national youth teams that feed the World Cup and professional ranks, you would find this strange phenomenon to be even more pronounced.

译文：如果你再去查看为世界杯和职业球队输送人才的欧洲国家青年队，你会发现这一奇怪现象甚至更加明显。

【核心词汇&短语】

- feed /fi:d/ v. 输送；喂养；供给（此处为考研高频熟词僻义）
- professional ranks 职业队伍，职业梯队
- pronounced /prə'naʊnst/ adj. 明显的，显著的

【长难句结构分析】

本句同样为虚拟语气句，句子主干为 **you would find this strange phenomenon to be even more pronounced**。

- 定语从句：**that feed the world cup and professional ranks**，修饰先行词 **the European national youth teams**，解释青年队的核心作用

第二段

1. **原句**：What might account for this strange phenomenon?

译文：是什么导致了这一奇怪的现象呢？

【核心词汇&短语】

- account for 导致；解释；占比（考研核心高频多义短语）

2. **原句**：Here are a few guesses: a) certain astrological signs confer superior soccer skills; b) winter-born babies tend to have higher oxygen capacity, which increases soccer stamina; c) soccer-mad parents are more likely to conceive children in springtime, at the annual peak of soccer mania; d) none of the above.

译文：以下是几种猜测：a) 某些星座能赋予人更高超的足球技能；b) 冬季出生的婴儿往往有更高的血氧容量，这能提升足球运动所需的耐力；c) 痴迷足球的父母更有可能在春季（每年足球狂热的高峰期）受孕；d) 以上都不对。

【核心词汇&短语】

- astrological /,æstrə'lɒdʒɪkl/ adj. 占星的，星座的
- confer /kən'fɜ:(r)/ v. 授予；赋予；商议（考研核心词）
- superior /su:'piəriə(r)/ adj. 更高的，更好的；上级的
- oxygen capacity 血氧容量，携氧能力
- stamina /'stæmɪnə/ n. 耐力，持久力
- conceive /kən'si:v/ v. 怀孕；构思；设想（考研核心词）
- mania /'meɪniə/ n. 狂热，热衷

【长难句结构分析】

本句主干为 **Here are a few guesses**，冒号后为4个并列选项，对 **guesses** 进行具体说明。

- b选项中包含非限制性定语从句 **which increases soccer stamina**，**which** 指代前文“冬季出生的婴儿血氧容量更高”这一完整内容
- c选项中 **at the annual peak of soccer mania** 为介词短语作后置定语，修饰 **springtime**，补充说明春季的时间特点

第三段

1. **原句**：Anders Ericsson, a 58-year-old psychology professor at Florida State University, says he believes strongly in “none of the above.”

译文：佛罗里达州立大学58岁的心理学教授安德斯·埃里克森表示，他坚信“以上都不对”。

【核心词汇&短语】

- believe in 相信；信任；坚信

2. **原句**: Ericsson grew up in Sweden, and studied nuclear engineering until he realized he would have more opportunity to conduct his own research if he switched to psychology.
译文: 埃里克森在瑞典长大, 曾学习核工程, 直到他意识到, 如果转攻心理学, 他会有更多机会开展自己的研究。

【核心词汇&短语】

- nuclear engineering 核工程
- conduct research 开展研究 (考研高频写作搭配)
- switch to 转向; 转攻 (考研核心短语)

3. **原句**: His first experiment, nearly 30 years ago, involved memory: training a person to hear and then repeat a random series of numbers.

译文: 近30年前, 他的首次实验与记忆力相关: 训练一个人先听一组随机的数字, 然后将其复述出来。

【核心词汇&短语】

- involve /ɪnˈvɒlv/ v. 涉及; 包含; 使参与 (考研核心高频词)
- random /ˈrændəm/ adj. 随机的, 随意的
- a series of 一系列的 (考研高频短语)

4. **原句**: "With the first subject, after about 20 hours of training, his digit span had risen from 7 to 20," Ericsson recalls.

译文: 埃里克森回忆道: "第一个实验对象在经过约20个小时的训练后, 数字记忆广度从7提升到了20。"

【核心词汇&短语】

- subject /ˈsʌbdʒɪkt/ n. 实验对象; 主题; 科目 adj. 受...支配的 (考研核心熟词僻义)
- digit span 数字广度, 数字记忆跨度
- recall /rɪˈkɔ:l/ v. 回忆; 召回; 回想 (考研核心词)

5. **原句**: "He kept improving, and after about 200 hours of training he had risen to over 80 numbers."

译文: "他不断进步, 在经过约200个小时的训练后, 他能记住的数字超过了80个。"

【核心词汇&短语】

- keep doing 持续做某事, 不断做某事

第四段

1. **原句**: This success, coupled with later research showing that memory itself is not genetically determined, led Ericsson to conclude that the act of memorizing is more of a cognitive exercise than an intuitive one.

译文: 这次实验的成功, 再加上后续表明记忆力本身并非由基因决定的研究, 让埃里克森得出结论: 记忆行为与其说是一种直觉活动, 不如说是一种认知训练。

【核心词汇&短语】

- coupled with 加上, 连同 (考研高频搭配, 写作可用)
- genetically /dʒəˈnetɪkli/ adv. 基因地, 遗传地
- conclude /kənˈklu:d/ v. 得出结论; 结束; 推断 (考研核心高频词)
- cognitive /ˈkɒgnətɪv/ adj. 认知的, 感知的
- intuitive /ɪnˈtju:ɪtɪv/ adj. 直觉的, 凭直觉的
- more A than B 与其说是B, 不如说是A (考研高频比较结构)

【长难句结构分析】

本句为考研核心长难句, **句子主干为** This success led Ericsson to conclude that...

- 插入定语: coupled with later research... 为过去分词短语作后置定语, 修饰主语 This success

- 嵌套定语: **showing that...determined** 为现在分词短语作后置定语, 修饰 **research**, 其中包含第一个宾语从句 **that memory itself is not genetically determined**
 - 宾语从句: **that the act of memorizing...intuitive one** 为第二个宾语从句, 作 **conclude** 的宾语, 其中包含 **more...than...** 比较结构, 明确对记忆行为的核心定性
2. **原句**: In other words, whatever inborn differences two people may exhibit in their abilities to memorize, those differences are swamped by how well each person “encodes” the information.

译文: 换句话说, 无论两个人在记忆能力上表现出怎样的先天差异, 这些差异都会被每个人对信息的“编码”能力所掩盖。

【核心词汇&短语】

- in other words 换句话说 (考研高频逻辑短语)
 - inborn /'ɪnbɔ:n/ adj. 天生的, 先天的
 - exhibit /ɪg'zɪbɪt/ v. 表现出; 展览; 展示 (考研核心词)
 - swamp /swɒmp/ v. 掩盖; 使陷入困境; 淹没 n. 沼泽 (考研高频熟词僻义)
 - encode /ɪn'kəʊd/ v. 编码; 把...译成密码
3. **原句**: And the best way to learn how to encode information meaningfully, Ericsson determined, was a process known as deliberate practice.
- 译文**: 埃里克森断定, 学习如何有意义地对信息进行编码的最佳方法, 是一个被称为“刻意练习”的过程。

【核心词汇&短语】

- meaningfully /'mi:nɪŋfəli/ adv. 有意义地
 - deliberate practice 刻意练习 (本文核心概念)
 - known as 被称为, 以...著称
4. **原句**: Deliberate practice entails more than simply repeating a task.
- 译文**: 刻意练习所需要的远不止是简单地重复一项任务。

【核心词汇&短语】

- entail /ɪn'teɪl/ v. 需要; 使必需; 牵涉 (考研核心词)
 - more than 不只是, 超过 (考研高频多义短语)
5. **原句**: Rather, it involves setting specific goals, obtaining immediate feedback and concentrating as much on technique as on outcome.
- 译文**: 相反, 它需要设定明确的目标、获取即时的反馈, 并且既要关注结果, 也要同等关注技巧。

【核心词汇&短语】

- rather adv. 相反, 反而 (考研高频逻辑转折词)
- specific /spə'sɪfɪk/ adj. 明确的, 具体的; 特定的 (考研核心高频词)
- immediate feedback 即时反馈
- concentrate on 专注于, 集中注意力于 (考研高频短语)
- as much A as B 既B也A, A和B同等重要 (高频比较结构)

第五段

1. **原句**: Ericsson and his colleagues have thus taken to studying expert performers in a wide range of pursuits, including soccer.

译文: 埃里克森和他的同事们由此开始研究包括足球领域在内的众多行业中的顶尖从业者。

【核心词汇&短语】

- thus /ðʌs/ adv. 因此, 由此 (考研高频逻辑词)
- take to doing sth. 开始做某事; 喜欢上做某事
- a wide range of 大范围的, 广泛的 (考研高频短语)
- pursuit /pə'sju:t/ n. 职业, 行业; 追求; 追赶 (考研核心熟词僻义)

2. **原句**: They gather all the data they can, not just performance statistics and biographical details but also the results of their own laboratory experiments with high achievers.

译文: 他们尽可能收集所有数据, 不仅包括表现统计数据和生平细节, 还包括他们自己对高成就者进行的实验室实验的结果。

【核心词汇&短语】

- statistics /stə'tɪstɪks/ n. 统计数据, 统计学
- biographical /,baɪə'græfɪkl/ adj. 传记的, 生平的
- laboratory experiment 实验室实验
- high achiever 高成就者, 成功者
- not just...but also... 不仅...而且... (考研高频并列结构)

3. **原句**: Their work makes a rather startling assertion: the trait we commonly call talent is highly overrated.

译文: 他们的研究得出了一个相当惊人的结论: 我们通常称之为天赋的特质被严重高估了。

【核心词汇&短语】

- startling /'stɑ:tln/ adj. 惊人的, 令人吃惊的
- assertion /ə'sɜ:ʃn/ n. 断言, 声明; 结论
- trait /treɪt/ n. 特质, 特征, 特点 (考研核心词)
- overrate /,əʊvə'reɪt/ v. 高估, 对...评价过高

4. **原句**: Or, put another way, expert performers – whether in memory or surgery, ballet or computer programming– are nearly always made, not born.

译文: 或者换句话说, 顶尖高手——无论是在记忆领域还是外科手术领域, 无论是芭蕾舞还是计算机编程领域——几乎都是后天练就的, 而非天生的。

【核心词汇&短语】

- put another way 换句话说 (同义替换in other words, 写作可用)
- surgery /'sɜ:dʒəri/ n. 外科手术; 外科
- ballet /'bæleɪ/ n. 芭蕾舞
- programming /'prəʊgræmɪŋ/ n. 编程, 程序设计

【长难句结构分析】

本句为全文主旨句, 句子主干为 expert performers are nearly always made, not born。

- 插入语: whether in...or... 为让步插入语, 对 expert performers 的领域进行补充说明, 两个破折号起到分隔插入语、突出主干的作用
- 核心结论: made, not born 是全文的核心观点, 点明后天培养的决定性作用

三、完整原文

①If you were to examine the birth certificates of every soccer player in 2006's World Cup tournament, you would most likely find a noteworthy quirk: elite soccer players are more likely to have been born in the earlier months of the year than in the later months. If you then examined the European national youth teams that feed the World Cup and professional ranks, you would find this strange phenomenon to be even more pronounced.

②What might account for this strange phenomenon? Here are a few guesses: a) certain astrological signs confer superior soccer skills; b) winter-born babies tend to have higher oxygen capacity, which increases soccer stamina; c) soccer-mad parents are more likely to conceive children in springtime, at the annual peak of soccer mania; d) none of the above.

③Anders Ericsson, a 58-year-old psychology professor at Florida State University, says he believes strongly in "none of the above." Ericsson grew up in Sweden, and studied nuclear engineering until he realized he would have more opportunity to conduct his own research if he switched to psychology. His first experiment, nearly 30 years ago, involved memory: training a person to hear

and then repeat a random series of numbers. “With the first subject, after about 20 hours of training, his digit span had risen from 7 to 20,” Ericsson recalls. “He kept improving, and after about 200 hours of training he had risen to over 80 numbers.”

④This success, coupled with later research showing that memory itself is not genetically determined, led Ericsson to conclude that the act of memorizing is more of a cognitive exercise than an intuitive one. In other words, whatever inborn differences two people may exhibit in their abilities to memorize, those differences are swamped by how well each person “encodes” the information. And the best way to learn how to encode information meaningfully, Ericsson determined, was a process known as deliberate practice. Deliberate practice entails more than simply repeating a task. Rather, it involves setting specific goals, obtaining immediate feedback and concentrating as much on technique as on outcome.

⑤Ericsson and his colleagues have thus taken to studying expert performers in a wide range of pursuits, including soccer. They gather all the data they can, not just performance statistics and biographical details but also the results of their own laboratory experiments with high achievers. Their work makes a rather startling assertion: the trait we commonly call talent is highly overrated. Or, put another way, expert performers – whether in memory or surgery, ballet or computer programming– are nearly always made, not born.

四、完整译文

①如果你去查看2006年世界杯足球赛所有参赛球员的出生证明，你极有可能会发现一个值得关注的奇特现象：优秀的足球运动员更有可能出生在一年的前几个月，而非后几个月。如果你再去查看为世界杯和职业球队输送人才的欧洲国家青年队，你会发现这一奇怪现象甚至更加明显。

②是什么导致了这一奇怪的现象呢？以下是几种猜测：a) 某些星座能赋予人更高超的足球技能；b) 冬季出生的婴儿往往有更高的血氧容量，这能提升足球运动所需的耐力；c) 痴迷足球的父母更有可能在春季（每年足球狂热的高峰期）受孕；d) 以上都不对。

③佛罗里达州立大学58岁的心理学教授安德斯·埃里克森表示，他坚信“以上都不对”。埃里克森在瑞典长大，曾学习核工程，直到他意识到，如果转攻心理学，他会有更多机会开展自己的研究。近30年前，他的首次实验与记忆力相关：训练一个人先听一组随机的数字，然后将其复述出来。埃里克森回忆道：“第一个实验对象在经过约20个小时的训练后，数字记忆广度从7提升到了20。他不断进步，在经过约200个小时的训练后，他能记住的数字超过了80个。”

④这次实验的成功，再加上后续表明记忆力本身并非由基因决定的研究，让埃里克森得出结论：记忆行为与其说是一种直觉活动，不如说是一种认知训练。换句话说，无论两个人在记忆能力上表现出怎样的先天差异，这些差异都会被每个人对信息的“编码”能力所掩盖。埃里克森断定，学习如何有意义地对信息进行编码的最佳方法，是一个被称为“刻意练习”的过程。刻意练习所需要的远不止是简单地重复一项任务。相反，它需要设定明确的目标、获取即时的反馈，并且既要关注结果，也要同等关注技巧。

⑤埃里克森和他的同事们由此开始研究包括足球领域在内的众多行业中的顶尖从业者。他们尽可能收集所有数据，不仅包括表现统计数据和生平细节，还包括他们自己对高成就者进行的实验室实验的结果。他们的研究得出了一个相当惊人的结论：我们通常称之为天赋的特质被严重高估了。或者换句话说，顶尖高手——无论是在记忆领域还是外科手术领域，无论是芭蕾舞还是计算机编程领域——几乎都是后天练就的，而非天生的。